MODULE 33 · FOUNDATIONS AND EXAM SKILLS - ALL DOMAINS

From AI-102 answers to AI-103 answers

Three states of a Microsoft answer, the translation tables, how to spot a stale option, and when the old answer is still right.

DOMAIN Exam skills WEIGHT - MODULE 33 of 39

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Every answer is in one of three states: **retired**, **legacy**, or **current**. Only one of those is what AI-103 rewards.

Which state is a feature in?

STATE	WHAT IT MEANS	IN AN EXAM ANSWER
Retired	Calls fail; the product is gone	Always wrong
Legacy	Supported for existing work, retirement dated	Right only for existing systems
Current	Recommended for new development	The default answer

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Retiring is not the same as wrong. A legacy feature can be the correct answer for an application that already uses it.

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Platform and agents

AI-102-ERA ANSWER	AI-103 ANSWER
Azure AI Studio, hub-based projects	Foundry portal and Foundry projects
Prompt flow for multi-step flows	Agent Framework workflows
Semantic Kernel or AutoGen	Microsoft Agent Framework
Threads, runs and agent IDs	Conversations, responses, agent name and version
Connected Agents tool	A2A tool, or Agent Framework orchestration
Azure OpenAI On Your Data	RAG with AI Search, or a knowledge base

ON THE EXAM

Agent Framework is Microsoft's stated unified foundation, bringing together Semantic Kernel and AutoGen.

Vision, language and search

AI-102-ERA ANSWER	AI-103 ANSWER
DALL-E 3 for images	GPT-image models
Image Analysis captions for describing images	Multimodal models, or Content Understanding
Key phrase extraction for topics	A model with a structured output schema
Language sentiment analysis for new apps	A model schema with labels and evidence
QnA Maker or LUIS	Foundry models, or Language's current features
Document Layout skill in new skillsets	Content Understanding skill

ON THE EXAM

Image Analysis still returns bounding boxes, which models don't. That capability is current until its 2028 retirement.

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Words that suggest an old answer

- **Studios and designers:** Language Studio, a visual flow designer, hub-based projects.
- **Old agent vocabulary:** threads, runs, agent IDs, connected agents.
- **Keys everywhere**, where Microsoft now recommends Entra ID and managed identity.
- **Named retired products:** QnA Maker, LUIS, DALL-E 3.
- **Version numbers:** Translator v3.0, Computer Vision 3.x, preview API dates now past.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> None of these guarantees a wrong answer. They're prompts to check the other options for a current equivalent.

Same thing, new name

YOU MAY SEE	NOW CALLED
Azure AI Studio	Microsoft Foundry portal
Azure AI Language	Azure Language in Foundry Tools
Azure AI Vision	Azure Vision in Foundry Tools
Azure AI Foundry Agent Service	Foundry Agent Service
Cognitive Services roles	Still exist, and still appear in RBAC

ON THE EXAM

Renames are cosmetic. Don't reject an option just because it uses an older brand name for the same service.

If two options both work, choose the one Microsoft recommends for **new development**, unless the question is about an **existing system**.

Dates worth carrying into the exam

- **Already gone:** QnA Maker, LUIS, DALL-E 3, Sora 1, Computer Vision 1.0 to 3.1.
- **2026:** On Your Data (14 October), Foundry workflows (1 December), Sora 2 preview (15 October).
- **2027:** Agents classic, threads and runs (31 March); prompt flow (20 April).
- **2028:** Entity linking (1 September); Custom Vision and Image Analysis (25 September).
- **2029:** Azure Language legacy features, including key phrases and sentiment (31 March).

> ON THE EXAM
>
> You won't be asked to recite dates. You'll be asked which option a team should build on now.

When the older answer is still right

- **Existing implementations**: the question asks for minimal change before a retirement date.
- **Capabilities with no successor yet**, such as bounding boxes from Image Analysis.
- **Deterministic extraction** from stable forms, where Document Intelligence still fits.
- **Containers and on-premises** requirements that only certain services meet.
- **Custom object detection**, where Microsoft points to Custom Vision.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> The exam rewards judgement, not reflexes. 'Newest' is a good default, not a rule.

What the wording is telling you

THE QUESTION SAYS	LEAN TOWARDS
'A new solution', 'you are designing'	The current, recommended service
'Minimal changes to an existing app'	The supported feature already in place
'Must be supported beyond 2028'	Something with no near retirement date
'No code', 'least effort'	Managed or prebuilt options
'Full control', 'custom logic'	SDK, custom skills, hosted agents

ON THE EXAM

Wording about new versus existing work is the single most reliable signal for old-versus-new questions.

> A practice question from older material asks how to build a multi-step pipeline that calls a model, then a tool, then another model, with monitoring and version control.
>
> Its stated answer is prompt flow. The team is starting this project today.

What's the current answer?

A Prompt flow, since it's still available and the practice answer says so.

B A Foundry workflow agent, designed in the portal's visual designer.

C Azure OpenAI On Your Data, which chains retrieval and generation.

D An Agent Framework workflow, hosted and traced in Foundry.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What's the current answer?

A Prompt flow.
Feature development ended in April 2026 and it retires in April 2027.

B Workflow agent.
The visual designer retires on 1 December 2026.

C On Your Data.
A retrieval feature, retiring 14 October 2026, not a multi-step pipeline.

D Agent Framework workflow.
Microsoft's current answer for multi-step orchestration, with tracing in Foundry.

THE SIGNAL

Three plausible options, three retirement dates. Only one is where Microsoft says to start today.

> An older question asks how to classify incoming support messages into intents, and extract entities such as order numbers, for a brand-new assistant.
>
> Its answer is conversational language understanding, which is still available today.

What should a team building this now use?

A Conversational language understanding, exactly as the older answer says.

B A Foundry model with a strict schema, plus NER for standard entities.

C QnA Maker, paired with LUIS for the entity extraction part.

D Key phrase extraction, treating the top phrase as the intent.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should a team building this now use?

A CLU as before.

Legacy: supported for existing work, retiring by March 2029, not for a new build.

B Model schema plus NER.

Classification by enum, entities from a core capability: the current combination.

C QnA Maker and LUIS.

Both retired. Any answer naming them is wrong.

D Key phrases as intents.

Legacy, and key phrases aren't a fixed intent set anyway.

THE SIGNAL

'Brand-new assistant' plus a legacy service in the stated answer: translate it to the current combination.

> A study guide chapter describes an orchestrator agent that routes questions to specialist agents using the Connected Agents tool, and returns their answers.
>
> The team is rebuilding this on the current Foundry Agent Service.

What replaces the Connected Agents tool?

A. The A2A tool, calling specialists that expose A2A endpoints.

B. Threads and runs, with the orchestrator polling each specialist run.

C. Prompt flow, with one node per specialist agent in the graph.

D. A single agent with all the specialists' instructions merged together.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What replaces the Connected Agents tool?

A The A2A tool.
Microsoft's named replacement: the answer returns to the calling agent.

B Threads and runs.
Agents classic vocabulary, retiring 31 March 2027.

C Prompt flow nodes.
Retiring, and never the agent-to-agent mechanism.

D One merged agent.
Abandons specialisation and security boundaries entirely.

THE SIGNAL

Connected agents don't exist in the new Agent Service. A2A, or an Agent Framework orchestration, takes over.

> A team maintains a chat app that grounds answers on company PDFs using Azure OpenAI On Your Data. It works today, and the team has no capacity for a rebuild this quarter.
>
> They ask what to do before the feature's retirement in October 2026.

What should you advise?

A. Nothing: On Your Data is supported, so the app will keep working indefinitely.

B. Rebuild immediately on prompt flow, which offers similar grounding nodes.

C. Plan migration to AI Search retrieval, before the date.

D. Switch the deployment to a newer model, which removes the dependency.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should you advise?

A Do nothing.
Retirement means requests fail. 'Works today' has an expiry date.

B Rebuild on prompt flow.
Migrating onto something that retires six months later.

C Plan migration to AI Search retrieval.
The current grounding approach, with time to migrate before the date.

D Newer model.
The dependency is the feature, not the model version.

THE TIEBREAKER

Legacy is a timer, not a reprieve. Keep running, but migrate towards the current answer before the date.

Old versus new in five lines

- **Three states:** retired is always wrong, legacy suits existing systems, current is the default.
- **Prompt flow, connected agents, On Your Data, CLU, key phrases** all have current replacements.
- **Renames aren't retirements.** Foundry portal, Azure Language, Azure Vision are the same services.
- **Watch for studios, threads, runs, keys and old version numbers** in options.
- **New build: current. Existing app, minimal change: legacy, until its date.**

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Next, module 34: confusion pairs, the services and settings most often mixed up.